

Case Study: Suspicious PowerShell Privilege Escalation Pattern on Web Server

Alert: Suspicious PowerShell Privilege Escalation Pattern Detected

Source: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Description: A security alert was triggered after suspicious PowerShell activity indicative of a potential privilege escalation attempt was detected on a web server. The activity may involve execution of encoded PowerShell commands, privilege modification, execution of administrative utilities, or attempts to bypass security controls. Such behavior may indicate an attacker attempting to gain elevated privileges following initial access.

Severity: Critical

Triggered Rules: Suspicious PowerShell Privilege Escalation Activity

MY IP

IP LOOKUP

HIDE MY IP

VPNS ▾

TOOLS ▾

IP Details For: 185.220.101.5

Decimal: 3118228741

Hostname: berlin01.tor-exit.artikel10.org

ASN: 60729

ISP: Stiftung Erneuerbare Freiheit

Services: [Tor Exit Node](#)

Forum spam source (80)

Country: Germany

State/Region: Hamburg

City: Hamburg

Latitude: 53.5753 (53° 34' 30.91" N)

Longitude: 10.0148 (10° 0' 53.20" E)



CLICK TO CHECK BLACKLIST STATUS

Latitude and Longitude are often near the center of population. These values are not precise enough to be used to identify a specific address, individual, or for legal purposes. IP data from [IP2Location](#).

Alert ID: 5021

Time : 7/6/2026,9:54:02 PM

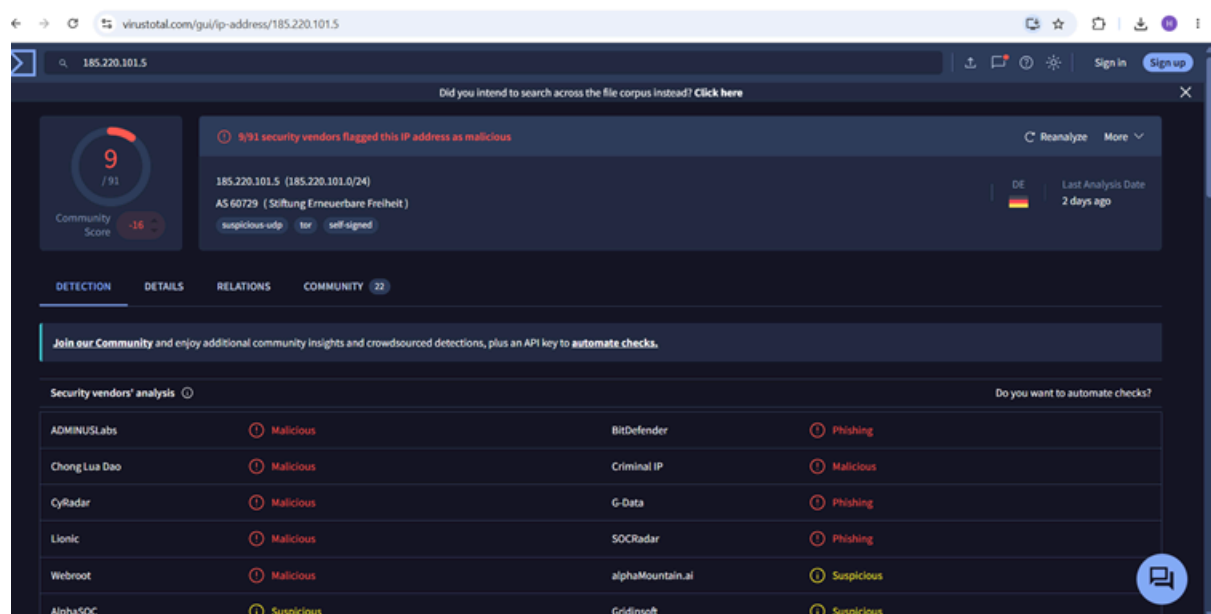
Source ip: 185.220.101.5

Destination ip: 10.0.115.42

Service : Windows PowerShell

User: Matthias Marx

Failed attempts : 20



Validity : True Positive

- The IOC **185.220.101.5** has a **moderate malicious reputation** according to VirusTotal, with **9 security vendors** detecting it as malicious and a **negative community score**. The IP is associated with the **Tor network**, which is frequently used by attackers to hide their origin. If this IP initiated communication with

internal assets or attempted authentication, the alert should be considered a **True Positive** and investigated further.